UpCircle Beauty

Company Overview UpCircle Beauty is a British skincare brand that has gained a cult following for its "circular" approach to beauty. They are known for taking leftover ingredients from the food and drink industry and transforming them into high-end serums, moisturizers, and scrubs.

ESG Focus: By-product Beauty (Upcycling Food Waste)



Why (The Problem) Every year, the food and beverage industry creates millions of tons of waste that still contain powerful nutrients. For example, coffee grounds are usually thrown away after one use, but they still contain high levels of antioxidants. If left in landfills, this organic waste rots and produces methane, a harmful greenhouse gas.

How (The Solution) UpCircle partners with local cafes and juice bars to collect ingredients that would otherwise be discarded. They collect used coffee grounds, discarded fruit stones (like apricot and olive), and even chai tea spices. These are then cleaned and processed in their lab to extract oils and vitamins for skincare.

What (The Outcome) This creates "Rescue-Based" skincare. Instead of depleting new natural resources, they use what already exists. Their products are high-performing—for instance, their coffee-based eye cream is naturally high in caffeine, which helps reduce puffiness and dark circles.

Impact: To date, UpCircle has saved over 450 tons of coffee grounds from going to landfills. They are B-Corp certified and use 99% plastic-free packaging, aiming to prove that a luxury beauty routine doesn't have to create a mountain of trash.